WEEK 4 · LESSON 22 OF 24 · HANDOUT

# AI Governance and Policy

Study time: **about 45 minutes** (reading, video and activity)

▶ **Watch:** https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9B02MzWwkSo — open the lesson online to watch inside the course.

**Your goal in this lesson:** Describe how governments and organisations govern AI, summarise Rwanda's National AI Policy and the EU AI Act's risk-based approach, and write simple governance rules for an organisation.

## What is AI governance?

**AI governance** is the set of rules, roles and processes that make sure AI is developed and used **safely, fairly, lawfully and for the public good**. It happens at three levels:

1. **International** — shared principles between countries.
2. **National** — laws, policies and regulators.
3. **Organisational** — a company's or ministry's own rules for using AI.

## International principles

- The **OECD AI Principles** (2019) — AI should be inclusive, respect human rights, be transparent, robust and safe, with clear accountability.
- The **UNESCO Recommendation on the Ethics of Artificial Intelligence** (2021) — adopted by UNESCO's member states, focused on human rights, fairness, environment and diversity.
- The **African Union Continental AI Strategy** (2024) — an African approach that stresses development, skills, inclusion and African data and languages.

## Rwanda's National AI Policy

Rwanda's Cabinet approved a **National Artificial Intelligence Policy in 2023**, developed by the Ministry of ICT and Innovation with partners including C4IR Rwanda. It aims to make Rwanda a leader in responsible, inclusive AI in Africa. Its priority areas include:

- **Skills** — AI literacy and 21st-century skills, from schools to universities.
- **Infrastructure and computing power** — the hardware and connectivity AI needs.
- **Data** — a strategy for making quality data available while protecting privacy.
- **Public sector** — trustworthy AI to improve government services.
- **Private sector** — helping businesses adopt AI widely.
- **Ethics** — practical guidelines for responsible AI.

This policy works together with the data-protection law you studied in Lesson 21.

## The EU AI Act — a risk-based model

The European Union's **AI Act** entered into force in **August 2024**, with its rules applying in stages. It matters to African companies too, because anyone offering AI in the EU must follow it. Its core idea is to **regulate according to risk**:

| Risk level | Examples | What the law requires |
|---|---|---|
| **Unacceptable** | Social scoring of citizens; manipulative systems that exploit vulnerable people | **Banned** |
| **High** | AI for hiring, credit scoring, education access, medical devices, critical infrastructure | Strict duties: risk management, quality data, documentation, human oversight, accuracy |
| **Limited** | Chatbots, AI-generated content | **Transparency**: tell people they are dealing with AI, label deepfakes |
| **Minimal** | Spam filters, AI in video games | No special duties |

The risk-based idea is useful everywhere: **the more an AI system can affect people's rights and safety, the more care and control it needs.**

## Governance inside an organisation

Every organisation that uses AI — a school, a bank, a start-up — should have simple, written rules:

1. **An AI use policy** — which tools staff may use, and for what.
2. **Data rules** — what information must never go into external AI tools.
3. **Risk review** — high-impact uses (people's money, jobs, health) need extra checks before launch.
4. **Human accountability** — a named person is responsible for each AI system.
5. **Transparency** — tell customers when AI is used and how to reach a human.
6. **Monitoring and incident reporting** — track problems and fix them.

**Remember this:** AI governance works at international, national and organisational levels. Rwanda has a National AI Policy (2023) and a data-protection law; the EU AI Act regulates by risk. Every organisation needs its own clear AI rules.

Name: _____ Date: _____

## Activity

### Task 1

Classify these systems using the EU AI Act risk levels: a CV-screening tool, a customer-service chatbot, a spam filter, a credit-scoring app, a system that scores citizens' behaviour.

### Task 2

Write a one-page AI use policy (six short rules) for a small business or school you know.

## Self-check

Think about your answers here, then take the quiz online — it is marked instantly and explains every answer.

1. What is AI governance?
   A. A programming language
   B. A type of neural network
   C. A data format
   D. Rules, roles and processes that keep AI safe, fair, lawful and beneficial
2. When did Rwanda's Cabinet approve the National AI Policy?
   A. 2016
   B. 2019
   C. 2023
   D. It has not been approved
3. What is the core idea of the EU AI Act?
   A. Rules depend on the level of risk a system poses
   B. All AI is banned
   C. AI needs no rules
   D. Only games are regulated
4. Under the EU AI Act, a system that socially scores citizens is…
   A. Limited risk
   B. High risk but allowed without rules
   C. Minimal risk
   D. Unacceptable — banned

5. An AI tool that screens job applicants is classed as…

A. Minimal risk
B. High risk, with strict duties
C. Unacceptable
D. Not AI

6. Which rule belongs in an organisation's AI policy?

A. No monitoring is needed
B. A named person is accountable for each AI system
C. Staff may paste any customer data into any AI tool
D. Never tell customers AI is used

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